Left vs Right Heart Failure

Adult Health | Cardiovascular

REMEMBER IT AS

Left = Lungs, Right = Rest of the body

- **Left-sided failure backs up into the LUNGS**
  Crackles, dyspnea, orthopnea, pink frothy sputum, cough.
- **Right-sided failure backs up into the REST of the body**
  JVD, dependent edema, weight gain, hepatomegaly, ascites.
- **Daily weight is the best fluid indicator**
  A gain of 1 kg (2.2 lb) is roughly 1 L of retained fluid.

NURSE TIP

Report a weight gain of more than 2-3 lb in a day or 5 lb in a week.